Chapter 8: Architecture Governance

Study Guide – based on Mastering the TOGAF® Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 8 (pp. 189-227)

Overview

Chapter 8 (pp. 189-227) of *Mastering the TOGAF® Standard* by Eric Jager covers **architecture governance** and the **Architecture Board**. Architecture governance is the set of policies, processes, procedures, and standards that control and manage an organization's architecture and its Architecture Capability. Jager frames it as a shared responsibility among business leaders, not only the CIO or CTO, and as the “leadership compass” that keeps architecture aligned with strategic goals. The chapter has three parts: the TOGAF Architecture Governance Framework (8.1), a ten-step method for implementing governance (8.2), and the Architecture Board, including its composition, responsibilities, and a ten-step setup method (8.3). It is part of the GREEN reading tour (see Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3).

Reading note: Jager separates what the TOGAF Standard says from his own opinions (for example, that a CEO should be added to the framework and that most boards are wrongly staffed by IT architects). Keep these apart when studying. Anything introduced as “personally, I believe” or as an anecdote is the author's view, not the Standard's.

Detailed Section Breakdown

8.1 Managing the Architecture (pp. 190-193)

- **Governance is a shared responsibility.** It is not owned by the CIO or CTO alone. Enterprise Architects, domain experts, and other team members provide essential input (p. 190).
- **Benefits.** A well-structured Architecture Governance Framework reduces costs and risks, and speeds up decision-making and project delivery (p. 190).
- **Purpose (TOGAF view).** Governance controls and manages the organization's architecture and the Architecture Capability, the executive body behind the architecture (p. 190).
- **The framework is a reference point, not a fixed template.** Figure 8-1 (p. 191) shows the TOGAF structure as a starting point. Jager stresses that it should be adapted to each organization, and that it is not the only correct representation (pp. 190-191).

In Figure 8-1 the **CIO/CTO** provides overall direction and directly manages the Architecture Board and the three capabilities below. The capabilities are performed by teams across the organization (pp. 191-192):

Capability	What it covers	Key roles / parties
Development	Designing the architecture	Chief Architect, Enterprise Architect, Segment Architect (formerly Domain Architect). Detailed in Ch. 10, Sec. 10.2.
Implementation	Turning the architecture into real change	Program Management Office (PMO), external vendors, implementation projects
Deployment	Putting the architecture into operation	Service management, operational systems. Care is needed where the architecture requires modifying or replacing existing systems.

All three capabilities use the **Architecture Repository** throughout the initiative. The repository describes the architecture, the processes and solutions to be used, regulatory requirements, and organizational standards. It is updated continuously so that it reflects the developing architecture (p. 192).

Jager's commentary (author's view): the CIO is usually placed in the IT department, although information ownership sits with the business, so the CIO arguably belongs on the business side. The CTO fits IT better. Nine out of ten organizations place the CIO in IT, and TOGAF assumes this too. Jager suggests adding the **CEO** to the framework (pp. 192-193).

8.2 Implementing Architecture Governance (pp. 193-204)

Phase G (Implementation Governance) of the Architecture Development Method (ADM) is where this section is put into practice (p. 193). Figure 8-2 (p. 194) lists the ten steps, which are summarized below. Each step has sub-activities.

#	Step	What it involves (sub-activities)
1	Establish the Architecture Governance Framework (pp. 194-195)	Stakeholder kick-off workshops; a **governance charter** defining scope (which areas are governed) and success criteria; select framework components (approvals, compliance reviews, architecture change management); set up the **Architecture Governance Board** (business leaders, IT leaders, EAs, project managers; regular meetings); formalize decision-making, review, and escalation processes.
2	Define Governance Roles and Responsibilities (pp. 195-197)	Role-definition workshop; detailed role descriptions covering reviews, compliance checks, and approvals; map activities to roles with a **RACI matrix** (Table 8-1).
3	Develop Governance Policies and Standards (p. 198)	Form a policy-drafting group (architects, business leaders, business representatives); start with high-level policies, then break them into standards for technology, processes, and data; review with stakeholders; publish and train.
4	Set Up an Architecture Compliance Process (pp. 198-199)	Build **compliance checklists** for each domain (Business, Data, Application, Technology); add checkpoints to the project lifecycle (design reviews, pre-deployment) that require Board sign-off; schedule compliance reviews; create an **exception-handling process** requiring a rationale and an agreed mitigation action plan.
5	Implement an Architecture Review Process (pp. 199-200)	Standard review templates (project context, compliance with Architecture Principles, risks, proposed solutions); schedule reviews at design and pre-deployment phases; prepare documents in advance; evaluate components against standards and record decisions and exceptions.
6	Establish Key Performance Indicators (pp. 200-201)	Agree KPIs with stakeholders (e.g., % of compliant projects, number of reviews, number of deviations or exceptions, time to resolve architecture issues); set **baselines and targets** (e.g., 90% compliant by year-end); build monitoring dashboards (see Figure 12-54, Ch. 12, Sec. 12.10.2).
7	Integrate Governance into the ADM (pp. 201-202)	Define governance checkpoints for each ADM phase (e.g., Phase B reviews to validate business alignment). Projects must not move to the next phase **without governance board sign-off**.
8	Develop a Communications Plan (p. 202)	Identify impacted audiences (project managers, developers, business stakeholders); create tailored materials (slide decks, FAQs, email templates); run workshops or recorded webinars. Detailed in Ch. 14, Sec. 14.3.3.
9	Automate Governance Processes (pp. 202-203)	Choose a governance tool (EA management software; see Ch. 7, Sec. 7.7.1); set up automated alerts for reviews that are due; configure reports on compliance KPIs and alignment with Architecture Principles.

#	Step	What it involves (sub-activities)
10	Ensure Continuous Improvement (p. 203)	Hold **quarterly governance reviews** with the board; gather feedback through surveys or informal interviews; adjust the framework, roles, and procedures, then document and communicate the changes.

RACI matrix (pp. 196-197)

A RACI matrix maps each governance activity to the roles involved. Table 8-2 defines the four responsibilities:

Letter	Meaning (per Table 8-2)
R – Responsible	The person who actually carries out the activity or process.
A – Accountable	The person ultimately accountable for the activity being completed appropriately. The responsible people are accountable to this person.
C – Consulted	People not directly involved in doing the work but who are consulted. May be a stakeholder or subject-matter expert.
I – Informed	People who receive the output or need to stay informed.

Jager's worked example (Table 8-1, p. 196): for **establishing the Architecture Governance Framework**, the Architect is **Accountable**, the Business Leader is **Responsible**, and the Project Manager is **Consulted**. The layout of Table 8-1 in the book is dense, so work through it row by row when studying. The chapter does not explicitly state a rule about how many A's an activity may have. Standard RACI practice is one A per activity, but check your course materials before relying on that.

Further reading cited by the chapter: *The TOGAF Leader's Guide to Establishing and Evolving an EA Capability*, Ch. 6, doc. G184; and the *Enterprise Architecture Capability and Governance* document, doc. C220 (for compliance).

8.3 Architecture Board (pp. 204-224)

What the Architecture Board is (pp. 204-206)

- The Architecture Board is the pivotal governance body. It oversees compliance, facilitates decisions, manages architecture-related risk, and reviews and approves architecture deliverables (p. 204).
- It manages the architecture roles **functionally, not hierarchically** (p. 204; Figure 8-1).
- **It is not a group of architects who discuss technical details.** The word “board” refers to the boardroom, so issues at this level are **strategic, not operational** (p. 205).
- TOGAF says the board is formed by senior management, ideally C-level management, key stakeholders, and domain experts. It is a cross-organization entity (p. 205).
- **Jager's observation (author's view):** in about nine out of ten organizations, the board is formed of IT architects. Strategic decisions are then made elsewhere, which keeps the Architecture Capability reactive (pp. 205-206).
- In the Figure 8-1 framework, the board is typically headed by the CIO or CTO, a C-suite executive. Jager argues that a CEO should be added as a third C-level role (p. 206).

8.3.1 Diverse leadership: CEO versus CIO/CTO (pp. 206-208)

Jager contrasts two scenarios, both built around a new law that forces changes to organizational structure, processes, information flows, and applications (pp. 206-207):

Aspect	Scenario 1: CEO leads the board	Scenario 2: CIO or CTO leads the board
Scope of architecture work	Broad. Spans multiple architecture domains and the whole organization.	Narrower. The CIO handles information delivery; the CTO handles technical design and implementation.
Strategic impact	Strategy is mapped across the entire organization.	Each leader owns only part of the strategy, so the scope shrinks to a small part of the EA.

Figure 8-3 (p. 208) shows a CEO-led board. The CEO directs both the CIO/CTO and the Architecture Board. The CIO/CTO manages the unit managers, who manage the development, implementation, and deployment teams. Direct CEO governance lets the board engage with strategic issues, anchoring the strategy in the architecture.

Architecture boards are not just for large organizations. Smaller and flatter organizations can benefit too, and they often need the architecture to work harder to maintain standards. What matters is **sponsorship**: someone high in the hierarchy needs real attention and interest, but that person does not have to be the CEO (pp. 208-209).

8.3.2 When to set up an Architecture Board (pp. 209-211)

Common **triggers** for creating a board (p. 209):

- Hiring a new CIO or CTO.
- Mergers or acquisitions.
- Organizational restructuring, whether or not due to significant business change or rapid growth.
- Recognition that the organization's strategy is not being implemented, or is being implemented poorly.

Sponsor versus board: a sponsor (often the CIO) is not enough. The board is needed to win organization-wide support, because it is the primary sponsor of architecture within the organization. The board itself needs a sponsor, ideally the CEO. The company's **board of directors** is an overlooked resource for members, since it has broad knowledge of the company and its competitors (pp. 209-210). Jager notes that in nine out of ten failed architecture efforts, the cause is a lack of involvement from senior management. Sponsorship should be secured **before** the work begins, and the board's involvement should run from planning into maintenance (pp. 210-211).

8.3.3 Key responsibilities (pp. 211-213)

Category	Responsibility	What it means
Strategic	Provide a solid basis for decision-making	Architecture decisions carry strategic weight, so the board should give solid advice.
Strategic	Ensure continued flexibility	Meet changing business needs and take advantage of new technologies, ways of working, and methods, while enforcing compliance.
Strategic	Improve architecture maturity	Decisions must never let maturity slip. They should aim to raise it, considering current and desired maturity levels.
Operational	Ensure effective and consistent management and implementation	Keep a fixed membership so architecture is not approached differently each time. Use fixed terms that end at different times to rotate members.
Operational	Provide advice and guidance	Test advice against the existing architecture. Experts turn the board's direction into concrete actions.

Category	Responsibility	What it means
Governance	Provide a process for accepting and approving architecture work	The process must be transparent and accessible to all stakeholders.
Governance	Implement a control mechanism	Validate that the final execution matches what was proposed. This usually happens in Phase G of the ADM.
Governance	Recognize divergence from the architecture	Identify and respond to deviations in a timely way. This is discussed further in Phase H of the ADM.

The board's roles and responsibilities should be formally defined and approved by the board's lead sponsor, ideally the CEO (p. 213).

8.3.4 Composition and size (pp. 213-215)

- **Size:** four or five **standing members**. Do not exceed ten (p. 213).
- **Rotation:** membership can rotate so that different senior managers hold decision-making authority. Use fixed terms that end at different times to keep continuity (pp. 213-214).
- **Stakeholder assignment:** each member can be assigned stakeholders who are represented at meetings. Members must engage with their stakeholders before meetings (p. 213).
- **Mix of levels:** the board should not be exclusively C-level. Lower-level managers and experts can join depending on the topic. They are **non-permanent** members (pp. 214-215).
- Jager's experience (author's view): a board made entirely of C-level executives tends to view issues too strategically, so implementation teams lack the information they need. A healthy mix covers strategic, tactical, and operational angles (pp. 214-215).
- The right size depends on the issue, the position of the Architecture Capability in the organization, and how the organization wants to handle architecture. The board must still be able to fulfil its key responsibilities (p. 215).

8.3.5 How to set up an Architecture Board (pp. 215-224)

Figure 8-4 (p. 216) shows the ten steps. The table below summarizes the key points of each:

#	Step	Key points
1	Define the purpose and scope	Objectives (architectural consistency, approving major decisions, alignment with business goals). Scope: domains, decision types, and level (enterprise, solution, or project). Governance principles such as simplicity, reusability, and adherence to standards.
2	Identify key stakeholders	Business stakeholders (essential), Enterprise Architects, Segment Architects, security and compliance representatives, IT leaders, and project managers. Define roles such as chairperson, secretary, and decision-makers.
3	Develop the board's operating model	Meeting cadence (weekly, biweekly, or ad hoc for urgent items). Standard agenda: review of previous decisions, new proposals, ongoing initiatives, risk and issue management. Decision-making by consensus or majority vote, with an escalation process.
4	Define the engagement model and workflows	Submission process with templates for proposals, impact assessments, and decision logs. Review criteria (strategic alignment, technical feasibility, risk, cost/benefit). Feedback and resubmission loop. Decisions documented centrally with their rationale.

#	Step	Key points
5	Establish key artifacts and tools	Architecture Principles, standards, and guidelines that the board enforces. Decision templates. Collaboration tools for documents, agendas, and minutes. Tracking and reporting tools for decisions, actions, and review status.
6	Pilot the board	Choose a low-risk pilot project. Run a full cycle from submission to decision and feedback. Gather feedback from board members and project teams. Refine the process.
7	Roll out organization-wide	Communicate the purpose and process. Onboard projects. Monitor metrics such as decision turnaround time, compliance, and project feedback. Iterate on the process.
8	Ensure ongoing communication and alignment	Regular updates to senior management. Cross-board collaboration (e.g., with a security board or an innovation board). Continuous education for members on trends that affect decisions.
9	Measure and optimize performance	KPIs such as decision turnaround time, adherence to standards, and **business value delivered**. Jager notes that business value is often forgotten. Use feedback loops and continuous improvement.
10	Celebrate successes and promote value	Publicize achievements and milestones. Keep communicating the board's value to secure ongoing buy-in from senior leadership.

Anecdote (author's experience): at a government regulator of the healthcare industry, the board consisted entirely of technicians and spent its time on deep technical detail, “akin to a meeting of systems engineers.” Jager gradually moved senior management into the discussion by creating an **architecture advisory group** for strategic issues. It was later renamed the “Architecture Board,” and the old group became the “Architects' Consultation.” Because nobody lost an outlet, there was virtually no opposition. This is a useful pattern for handling resistance to a change in governance.

8.4 Summary (pp. 224-227)

The summary repeats the ten steps for implementing governance and the ten steps for setting up the board. Its key messages are:

- Architecture governance controls and manages the architecture and the Architecture Capability. The framework shows possible structure, not a single required one.
- The ideal board is C-level management plus key stakeholders plus domain experts, because strategic decisions about architecture should be made there.
- A board is essential for most organizations. Triggers can create it when it does not yet exist. It is the primary sponsor of architecture, and it needs its own top-level sponsor.
- The board should not be exclusively C-level. Mix in lower-level managers and experts.

Key Terms & Definitions

Architecture Governance (p. 189) — The policies, processes, procedures, and standards that streamline architectural needs and control and manage the architecture and the Architecture Capability.

Architecture Governance Framework (pp. 190-191) — The TOGAF reference structure for governance: CIO/CTO direction, the Architecture Board, and the development, implementation, and deployment capabilities. It is a starting point to adapt.

Architecture Capability (p. 190) — The executive body behind the architecture; the organization's ability to practice architecture (see also Ch. 9).

Development / Implementation / Deployment capabilities (pp. 191-192) — The three capabilities under the CIO/CTO. They design the architecture, implement it through projects, and deploy it into operations.

Architecture Repository, as used in governance (p. 192) — The continuously updated store of the architecture, processes, regulatory requirements, and organizational standards, used by all capabilities.

Phase G, Implementation Governance (p. 193) — The ADM phase in which the governance approach is put into practice.

RACI matrix (pp. 196-197) — A table mapping activities to roles: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed.

Compliance checklist (p. 199) — Checklists per architecture domain (Business, Data, Application, Technology) that detail compliance requirements aligned with governance policies.

Exception handling process (p. 199) — A formal route for raising deviations from standards to the governance board, with a rationale and a mitigation action plan.

Architecture review process (p. 199) — A formal review of architecture documents using templates, with decisions and exceptions recorded.

KPI, Key Performance Indicator (p. 200) — A measurable indicator of governance performance, set against a baseline and a target.

Architecture Board (p. 204) — A senior, cross-organization body (C-level, key stakeholders, domain experts) that oversees architecture compliance, decisions, and risk. It is not a group of architects.

Functional vs. hierarchical management (p. 204) — The Architecture Board manages architecture roles functionally (through governance), not through a line-management reporting chain.

Architecture sponsor (p. 210) — A senior executive who champions architecture. The board needs a sponsor of its own, ideally the CEO.

Standing vs. non-permanent members (pp. 213-215) — Four or five permanent board members, plus lower-level managers and experts who join depending on the topic.

Figures & Tables Referenced

Item	Page	Description and significance
Figure 8-1 – Architecture Governance Framework	p. 191	The TOGAF governance structure: CIO/CTO, the Architecture Board, and the three capabilities. The chapter's main reference diagram.
Figure 8-2 – Ten steps for implementing architecture governance	p. 194	Overview of the implementation steps in Section 8.2.
Table 8-1 – Example RACI Matrix	p. 196	Activities against Architect, Business Leader, and Project Manager. The worked example is the framework activity.
Table 8-2 – The four RACI responsibilities explained	p. 197	Definitions of R, A, C, and I.
Figure 8-3 – Architecture Board led by the CEO	p. 208	CEO directs both the CIO/CTO and the Architecture Board.
Figure 8-4 – Ten steps for setting up an Architecture Board	p. 216	Overview of the board setup steps in Section 8.3.5.

Key Takeaways / Exam Focus Points

- Architecture governance is a **shared responsibility**, not a CIO/CTO task. It controls and manages the architecture and the Architecture Capability (pp. 190-191).
- The CIO/CTO directs the Architecture Board and three capabilities: **development, implementation, deployment** (p. 191).
- The ten implementation steps, in order: (1) establish the framework, (2) define roles and responsibilities, (3) develop policies and standards, (4) set up compliance, (5) implement the review process, (6) establish KPIs, (7) integrate into the ADM, (8) develop a communications plan, (9) automate, (10) ensure continuous improvement (Figure 8-2).
- RACI: **R** does the work, **A** is ultimately accountable, **C** is consulted, **I** is informed (Table 8-2).
- **Phase G** of the ADM is where governance is put into practice. Phase H is where deviations are recognized (pp. 193, 211-213).
- Architecture Board triggers: new CIO/CTO hire, mergers or acquisitions, organizational restructuring, and poor strategy implementation (p. 209).
- A board is **not** a group of architects. It deals with strategic, not operational, issues (p. 205).
- Board responsibilities: **strategic** (basis for decisions, flexibility, maturity), **operational** (consistent management, advice and guidance), and **governance** (approval process, control mechanism, recognizing divergence) (pp. 211-213).
- Composition: four or five standing members, not more than ten. Mix C-level leaders with lower-level managers and experts (pp. 213-215).
- Jager's CEO-led scenario gives the broadest and most strategic scope. The CIO/CTO scenario narrows the scope to information delivery or technical design (pp. 206-208).
- The ten board setup steps, in order: define purpose and scope, identify stakeholders, operating model, engagement model, key artifacts and tools, pilot, roll out, communication and alignment, measure and optimize, celebrate successes (Figure 8-4).
- **Exam caution:** separate the Standard's view from Jager's opinions (the CEO as a third C-level role, the “nine out of ten” observations, and the personal anecdotes).

Self-Check Questions

Q: Who provides the overall direction in the TOGAF Architecture Governance Framework, and which bodies does that role directly manage?

A: The CIO/CTO provides overall direction. This role directly manages the Architecture Board and the development, implementation, and deployment capabilities (p. 191).

Q: Name the three roles the framework distinguishes within the development capability.

A: Chief Architect, Enterprise Architect, and Segment Architect (the former Domain Architect) (p. 191).

Q: What is the purpose of the Architecture Repository in the governance framework?

A: It describes the architecture, the processes and solutions to be used, regulatory requirements, and organizational standards. All capabilities use it, and it is updated continuously (p. 192).

Q: In a RACI matrix, what does the Accountable role mean compared with the Responsible role?

A: The Responsible person actually carries out the activity. The Accountable person is ultimately answerable for the activity being completed appropriately, and the Responsible people answer to them (pp. 196-197).

Q: What does the compliance process require when a project cannot meet a standard?

A: A formal exception-handling process: the deviation is raised to the governance board with a rationale, and an action plan for mitigation is agreed (p. 199).

Q: Why does Jager say a board is “not a group of architects”?

A: The word “board” refers to the boardroom, where issues are strategic rather than operational. The board should be made up of senior management, key stakeholders, and domain experts (p. 205).

Q: List four triggers for creating an Architecture Board.

A: A new CIO/CTO is hired; mergers or acquisitions; organizational restructuring (with or without business change or rapid growth); recognition that strategy is not being implemented or is implemented poorly (p. 209).

Q: Why is a sponsor alone not enough, according to the chapter?

A: An executive sponsor is not enough to win organization-wide support. The Architecture Board is needed as the primary sponsor of architecture, and the board itself needs a top-level sponsor, ideally the CEO (pp. 209-210).

Q: What is the recommended size of an Architecture Board, and what happens when it is made entirely of C-level executives?

A: Four or five standing members, and not more than ten. An all-C-level board tends to view architecture issues too strategically, leaving implementation without the information it needs (pp. 213-215).

Q: What are the three categories of Architecture Board responsibilities?

A: Strategic (basis for decision-making, continued flexibility, improving maturity), operational (effective and consistent management, advice and guidance), and governance (approval process, control mechanism, recognizing divergence) (pp. 211-213).

Q: In the setup steps, why does Jager say business value must be measured?

A: Business value is often forgotten because people get caught up in content issues. Measuring the value it delivers keeps the board's value proposition visible (p. 223).

Q: Which step of the implementation method covers integrating governance into the ADM, and what rule applies at milestones?

A: Step 7. Governance checkpoints are defined for each ADM phase, and projects must not proceed to the next phase without governance board sign-off (pp. 201-202).